

From 67 to 60 BCE, the great Roman general Pompey defeated pirates across the

By 51 BCE, Caesar was a major political figure. **◀ 108–09.** The Roman Senate and Julius Caesar's former ally, Pompey, felt increasingly threatened by his growing power. In 49 BCE, Caesar took Rome, and war broke out between him and the Senate's forces, now led by Pompey. **Pompey was murdered by**

In 44 BCE, **Caesar was murdered** by a group of senators. His successors—the Roman general Mark Antony, and Octavian, Caesar's adopted son—became unable to work together, and divided Rome's empire into west (Octavian), and east (Antony). Friction between the two sparked **civil war**, further weakening the republic.

PORTRAIT OF MARK ANTONY

The Roman Empire reached its greatest extent in 117 CE, at the start of the reign of emperor Hadrian (ruled 117–138 CE), as shown by this map. The great structures for which Rome has become famed—from walls and aqueducts to amphitheaters and temples—appeared all over the empire, and many still survive today.

Emperor Hadrian supervised the building of this wall, which bears his name. Built on the northern border of the empire, Hadrian's Wall stretched for almost 75 miles (120 km), coast to coast across northern Britain.



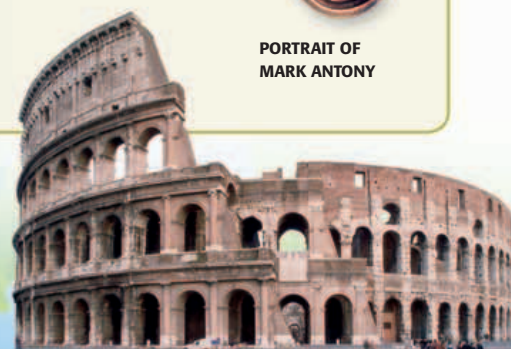
Mosaics, buildings, and
streets have survived
at the site of the Roman
city of Italica, close to
modern Seville.



The Pont du Gard aqueduct (an artificial waterway) was built c. 19 BCE to carry water from Uctia (Uzès) to Nemausus (Nîmes), France. With three tiers of arches and a height of nearly 165 ft (50 m), it was the highest aqueduct built by the Romans.



Mount Vesuvius erupted in 79 CE, burying Pompeii in ash (see p.112). It preserved a typical Roman town, complete with villas decorated with wall paintings, such as this example depicting a Roman girl.



The Colosseum, Rome, is a massive amphitheater that was originally called the Flavian amphitheater, as it was built by the Flavian emperors. The site of countless gladiatorial combats, its formal opening in 80 CE was marked by 100 days of gladiatorial games.



The temple of Jupiter near Sbeitla, Tunisia, is one part of the impressive remains of the ancient Roman city of Sufetula, which probably originated as a fort during campaigns against Numidian rebels.